# 2005 Honda Accord LX

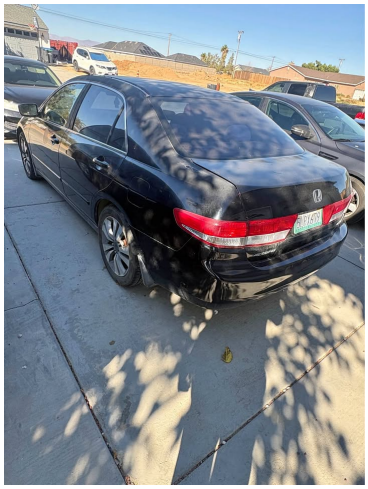
$3,000 · 220,000 miles · Private seller · California City, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

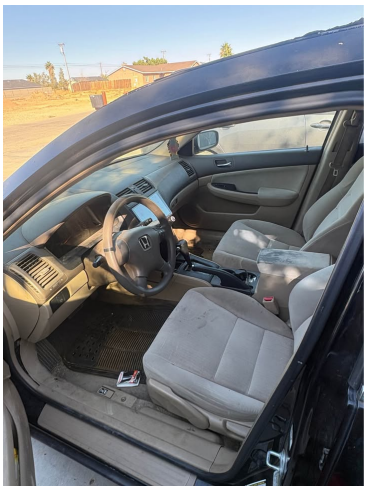
Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/1150594717632968/

Report generated October 30, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$3,452** | **$397** | **Good** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 4/5 · 24 recalls · 686 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $3,000.00 |
| Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV | $277.50 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $19.50 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $32.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $3,452.00 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $3,452.00 |
| Amount financed | $0.00 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $3,602.00 |

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $0.00 |
| Insurance (estimate, liability) | $70.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 24 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $197.92 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $115.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $14.12 |
| Total per month | $397.04 |

Running costs without the loan: **$397/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$8,366** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Good (4/5)**

Good model with the 4-cylinder (2.4L K24 is very durable). But this car has 220k miles, and the 2005 Accord has 24 recalls - mostly Takata airbag inflators, which are dangerous if not replaced.

NHTSA data for this model year: 24 recalls · 686 owner complaints (96 involving a crash). Most complaints: Air Bags (226), Power Train (114), Electrical System (99), Vehicle Speed Control (59), Service Brakes (53), Steering (42).

**Known issues for this model**

• Takata airbag inflators (multiple recalls) - can rupture and spray metal

• Automatic transmission software/secondary shaft recall (4-cyl 2005-2010)

• V6 automatics in this generation fail often (avoid V6)

• Power steering pump leaks/whine

• Door lock actuators, A/C compressor clutch

• 220k miles = wear items everywhere

**Check on this car before buying**

• Confirm 4-cylinder

• Run VIN: Takata airbag recalls MUST be completed

• Seller must provide smog cert (listing says 'needs smog')

• Test shifting: no flare/slip between gears

• Look for oil leaks, check suspension bushings

## Notes

IN-TOWN CAR (~$3k, for getting to and from work in Ridgecrest; not a DoorDash pick).

$3,000 negotiable, 220k, automatic, black/tan. Clean title, tags paid, CarPlay installed.

Says 'needs a smog' - in CA the SELLER must provide a passing smog cert. Don't buy until it passes.

Budget backup. Confirm 4-cyl (V6 auto in this gen has weak transmissions). Very high miles.

2026-10-29: back to Interested as an IN-TOWN CAR. Still listed.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.